

PLANNING TEMPLATE

FictionLab Scenario Planner

Build a scenario with a clear hook, durable story engine, and room to keep moving.

PDF for easy reading + editable Word edition

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How to use this

Work through this in order or jump to the part currently fighting you. Short answers are allowed. The goal is a scenario you can build and test, not a beautiful pile of notes.

Best used when: you have a premise but need a playable structure.

1. The core idea

Start with what makes the scenario hard to leave.

What happens in one sentence?

Use a person, a problem, and immediate pressure.

Why does the player have to engage?

Give them a need, duty, danger, secret, or relationship they cannot simply walk away from.

What keeps generating new scenes after the opening?

List conflicts, routines, mysteries, obligations, or changing relationships.

2. Player role

Make the player important without deciding every feeling for them.

Who is the player in this world?

Role, age range if relevant, pronouns, skills, position, and what is customizable.

What is fixed about them?

Only keep facts the scenario truly needs.

What choices remain open?

Personality, attraction, morals, alliances, appearance, or history.

3. Cast and dynamics

Distinct characters create better long games than a crowded list of attractive names.

Who are the essential characters?

For each: role, immediate want, pressure point, and relationship to the player.

How does each person speak and act differently?

Use concrete habits, not just adjectives.

Which relationships can change over time?

Name the starting state and at least two believable directions.

4. World and memory

Save only the details the roleplay needs to recall.

Which places will recur?

Write what happens there and why the location matters.

Which facts must never drift?

Names, bonds, rules, secrets, injuries, promises, or timelines.

Which lore belongs in memory cards?

One topic per card. Give it a clear retrieval phrase.

5. Opening setup

The first message should create motion, not explain the entire universe.

Where does the opening begin?

Choose a place with pressure already present.

What changes before the message ends?

An arrival, demand, discovery, mistake, threat, invitation, or interruption.

What can the player do immediately?

Offer several natural responses without listing them like a menu.

6. Paste-ready build summary

Title

One-line hook

Player role

Main cast

Opening situation

Long-game fuel

Core content labels

Memory cards needed

First testing goal
